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mha IT Services

IT Customer Handbook

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About the Support Handbook

This Handbook is here to provide you with high level information about our IT Team, support services and getting the best from logging a ticket with IT (via the MHA ticket management tool called 4me).

Our Goal for Continual Improvement

MHA IT Support is committed to delivering an exceptional service.

Working in collaboration with the organisation, our partners and suppliers, the IT goal is to ensure an effective and efficient service delivery. We continually review our practices to improve internal operations.

IT Support Services

Below are examples for support, these are not exclusive:

- System Solutions (additional support for software and systems inclusive of environment management)
- Data Governance (transfer of data between systems, processing of data files, management of databases)
- Hardware (physical parts of a computer, including external devices such as a monitor, mouse, keyboard, and speakers)
- Infrastructure (networking, data centres, site to site connection, firewall security)

Support Services

Our support teams are staffed with experienced and knowledgeable support professionals. Key services are:

- Incident management
- Ongoing problem management
- General system queries and advice
- Change management – for changes in software configuration
- Security/Access management
- Software version and configuration management
- Support with supplier relationship and contract management
- Management of environments and hosted services

All incoming enquiries are answered directly by a systems analyst allocated according to expertise and availability. The support management team monitor open

incidents and make available appropriate resources to help in resolution of support cases. This process ensures a high standard of customer service is maintained.

Types of Support Request

MHA IT Support categorise requests in one of four ways:

Case Record Type	Definition
Incident	An Incident is an unplanned interruption to an IT service or reduction in the quality of an IT service
Request for Information (RFI)	A RFI is a user request for information or advice.
Request for Change (RFC)	A RFC is a formal request for an adjustment to the product. This also includes enhancement requests (a request to add or improve functionality of the software, solve usability problems or introduce new features)
Problem	A Problem is a root cause of one or more Incidents. A Problem is usually raised in response to one or more incidents.

Priority Matrix

MHA IT Support have four primary levels for logging tickets within the MHA ticket management tool:

Level	Scope	Impact	Urgency
Top	Service down for several users	The issue affects most users on a business essential part of the application	Functionality that is used daily, not all day.
High	Service degraded for several users	The issue affects a limited number of users on a business essential part of the application	Functionality that needs to be used in the next 7 working days.
Medium	Service down for one user	The issue affects most users on a non-business essential part of the application	Functionality that needs to be used in the next 14 working days.
Low	Service degraded for one user	The issue affects a limited number of users on a non-business essential part of the application	Functionality that needs to be used in the next 28 working days.

Note, there is a fifth level for critical incidents. A critical incident means immediate action is needed and is defined by:

Level	Scope	Impact	Urgency
Critical	Service down for entire organisation; impacts user security; legislative-payment deadlines	The issue affects any number of users, preventing or delaying any business-critical activity	Functionality that is used constantly every day, all day.

‘How To…’ Documents

As the business area will understand their day-to-day interactions with their systems and their end customers the expectation is that the business will produce and maintain their operational ‘How To’ instructions.

If the business area feels they have lost some complex or technical knowledge, please speak to the IT support service for help in writing the documentation.

MHA IT Support will produce and maintain technical ‘How To’ instructions. These will be specific to the services which IT Team provide.

Maintaining ‘How To’ material is embedded into continual improvement; therefore, the team are committed to completing regular reviews.

Before You Contact Us

Below are steps you can take to ensure your query is progressed effectively.

1. **Ask a colleague:**
   Sometimes it is worth asking a colleague to complete the same actions to see they encounter the same issue or if they receive a different outcome.

2. **Use your in-team experts:**
   This person is your go-to person who knows the most about the system you are using within your team (this go-to person may also be called a ‘super user’ or ‘system expert’).

   Please speak to this person in before raising a ticket with IT, they may have experienced your query before so can provide you with the steer you need.

   If they also experience system issues, and they have completed specific checks, then this person would be the best person to raise a ticket on your behalf. This person will need to specify what checks they have completed.

3. **Recreate and document:**
   When logging a ticket, please provide what actions have been taken to recreate the issue. Please provide any supporting screenshots. This will help to have a s swift and efficient resolution.

   If this information is not provided up front, our support teams will ask for this information as they will need to understand the steps you took which led to the issue. Please note where tickets require vendor support or code changes, the vendor support teams may require a greater level of detail.

4. **Be explicit and don't assume.**
   IT and vendor support might not have encountered your query before. Providing as much detail as you can and being clear with the steps taken for recreating the issue is key.

How to contact us

4me Self-Service

The preferred way to log a support request with the MHA IT Support Services is by using the 4me self-service portal located at: https://mha.4me.com/self-service.

If you do not have access to the above alternative options for submitting a ticket are provided below.

Email

Another approach is to submit a support request to ITServiceDesk@mha.org.uk. When emailing, please ensure you provide as much detail as you can. Below is what makes a clear request and helps in swift and efficient resolution of it.

- Whether you believe it to be
  - An Incident
  - A Request for Change (RFC)
  - A Request for Information (RFI)
- What you require or what you were trying to do during the issue
- Details of the issue you have encountered
- When the issue occurred, and whether it can be replicated
- Provide the steps you have taken so we can recreate the issue
- The affected application(s)
- The number of users affected
- The priority you would assign to it
- Screen shots so our analysts can see what you see

This above information allows the Service Desk to route your case to the most appropriate Team within IT. Following further investigation, the case may still need to

be reassigned to ensure that cases receive the appropriate level of attention either within MHA IT or with MHA suppliers.

Telephone Support

Another way to contact the Service Desk to log a support request is to call 01332 221 888, selecting option2. If a member of the Service Desk is available, they will be able to respond to your call and immediately assist you with your issue.

If the call goes to voicemail, please provide **your name and your contact number along with high-level details of your request or issue**. Without a number to call, our Service Desk will not be able to contact you to assist you with your issue.

Knowledge Base

Our knowledge base will continually be developed in response to common issues and questions; we are committed to ensuring that it is wide ranging and comprehensive.

IT Support Hours of Operation

MHA IT Support Services are available between:

- Telephone support: 8:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M. Monday – Friday
    - Calls are not guaranteed to be answered outside business hours

- Email support: Monitored 8:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M. Monday – Friday
    - Emails received outside of office hours will be picked up the next working day

- Onsite assistance can be negotiated for extreme circumstances during the business week

How to Escalate an Incident

MHA IT Support have internal procedures in place to monitor and internally escalate incidents. There may be occasions where you may wish to escalate the incident.

An escalation should be used when you feel the normal support process is failing to provide an adequate resolution to an incident, and such failure is negatively affecting your business operation.

An escalation can be requested either via the 4me ticketing system:

1) By replying to any of the emails sent by IT Service Desk using the email: ithelpdesk@mha.org.uk

   or

2) By using the following itescalations@mha.org.uk. When using this email, please remember to provide your 4me ticket reference in the subject.

Once an escalation is logged on the case, the relevant MHA IT Support Analyst will be alerted to initiate the relevant actions – these actions will depend on the circumstances and the incident/issue itself.

Support Delivery Information

Remote Access

You will need to allow IT Support to remotely control your machine and wait to action any requests by the analyst.